LVNA
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VILLAGER

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– NEXT LVNA MEETING –

Our next general meeting will be on **Wednesday, December 9th, at 7:00 PM**, via Zoom. Our guest speaker will be a familiar face! Officer Spencer Chen, from the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety, will be joining us again to discuss what we can do as a community to be more active in the prevention of vandalism and other crimes and the potential next steps we can take to implement an official Neighborhood Watch program, as well as to follow up on some of the topics that were discussed during the September LVNA meeting. Plus, this is a great chance to ask any questions you may have or raise additional concerns that weren't covered in the previous discussion. Zoom meeting credentials will be available 1 hour before the start of the meeting at lvnasv.org/meeting

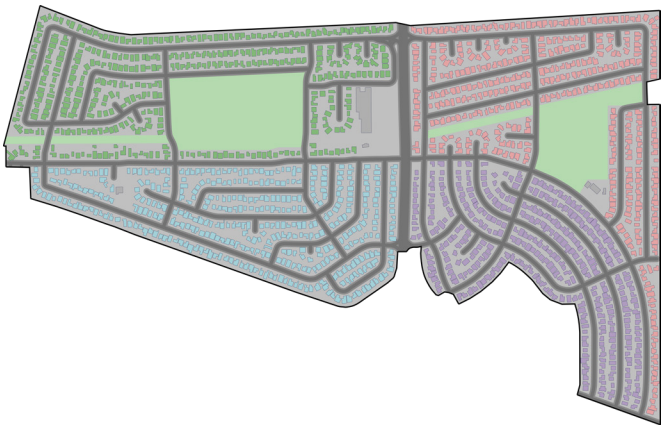
HOLIDAY LIGHTS

Can you believe it's already that time of year again? The Lakewood Village holiday lighting competition is back!

All homes within Lakewood Village are automatically entered into the competition; so, get those decorations ready! Lights and decor must be up by Sunday, December 13th, for consideration by the judging panel. Our team of volunteers will be out perusing the neighborhood for the most festive displays and documenting their findings with notes and photos. Our judges will then venture out on a neighborhood field trip for a final in-person viewing of the finalists before casting their votes for the winners of each quadrant.

Each winning home will receive a $25 gift card, along with the coveted bragging rights of one of the best Lakewood Village light displays of 2020. To make things more fair, winners from last year will be excluded from this year's voting.

Interested in sizing up the competition for your quadrant? Check out the map, to the right, to see which houses you're up against. We fully condone a little bit of healthy competition to help brighten up the neighborhood (yes, pun very much intended).





DO YOU WANT TO FIND OUT WHAT YOUR HOME IS WORTH?

Ask Grace Keng Realtor
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FACTOID



What's that?! Every few months a conversation pops up on Nextdoor about what these interesting critters are, followed by a debate on what to call them.

To kick this off scientifically, the "cute" little critter, to the right, is an opossum, or, more specifically, a Virginia opossum (Didelphis virginiana). These are the only marsupials found north of Mexico. Their name is actually derived from "aposoum," which is Powhatan, a Native American language, for "white animal." However, the ones we see in Lakewood Village are typically grayer, with the white portions predominantly appearing only on their faces.

Opossums can have 50 teeth and may appear dangerous, but they're not at all aggressive. Unless you try to grab them, they won't bite you. They also won't try to chase you or your pets, but they may hiss or growl if they're spooked. They may also attempt their signature move – "playing possum," by acting sick and/or dead, if they feel threatened. If you'd prefer to discourage them from hanging out around your house, be sure not to leave out any dog or cat food and to pick up garbage and fruits/veggies that drop from your trees. They may try to climb a tree if they see something scrumptious up there, but they're much more interested in opportunistic treats, so they'd be more inclined to visit those of us who aren't quite as quick to pick up fallen fruit. These guys are great to have around the neighborhood, though, so if you don't mind them wandering around your yard, you may benefit from their scavenging omnivorous tendencies. Opossums are great at cleaning up dead animals (including the bones), like road-kill; eating slugs, snails, and other bugs that make our gardens unhappy; and they'll gladly help us out with the fallen fruit issue we mentioned above. They're basically procrastinators' heroes!

Now, why the confusion for what to call them? Well, there's a group of marsupials native to Australia that got their name from their resemblance to the opossums we have here in North America. The Australasian name for the similar-looking marsupials is just "possum," without the leading "O." So between our innate American need to drop useless syllables and an already-existing word for a different animal, here we are with a justified reason for mix-ups. If you're speaking with someone colloquially, either option is acceptable {opossum, possum}. But, if you're writing a scientific paper, it's best to go with the "O" for our native Virginia opossums. In case it makes you feel better, they have the same confusion over in Australia and New Zealand.

LVNA MEETING RECAP

LVNA MEETING ON NOV 11

Sunnyvale's district 6 city council winner, Omar Din, joined us and our fellow district 6 neighborhoods for a virtual meet and greet. Din provided an overview of how he got to where he is today, starting with his parents emigrating from Pakistan in the 80s, through his education at DeAnza and a public policy program at Cornell, to his work with congressman Mike Honda and assemblyman Evan Low.

Key initiatives: housing affordability, livability (traffic, infrastructure, etc.), radical sustainability – most of district 6 is at sea level, COVID-19 response.

Some Examples from Resident Q&A:
Is a council member a full-time or part-time position? Council is a part-time position.
Northern Sunnyvale has a stigma of being a lower-class section of Sunnyvale. Why is that and how can we change it? Sunnyvale is often thought of as being split (northern Sunnyvale and all the rest; split at 101). A big part is due to resources being consolidated in the southern part (retail, restaurants, etc.). This is the first time we've had district representation and, historically, council members have predominantly lived in the southern part of Sunnyvale. The culture tends to form around that. As a result, Downtown gets prioritized. My plan for fixing that has a couple parts: change the culture around it; and we can do that by placing more of the city resources in the northern part. Example: Lakewood branch library. We should utilize that to have more presence in the northern part (commission meetings, public city meetings, info sessions, etc.). The other part is getting more retail and food resources up here.

We are super happy to announce that Councilmember Din has agreed to join us for a follow-up meeting, and potentially subsequent discussions, to provide updates on the activities/initiatives from the council/mayoral level, as well as getting feedback from district 6 residents on topics of interest.

Discussion Topics for Follow-Up:
- Dangerous intersections, speeding, and donuts in the neighborhoods.
- Traffic from new housing/retail.
- Litter/debris around the city – potential programs to improve it, similar to San Jose.
- Residents having a voice (split trashcan initiative, Lakewood swimming pool removal, etc.).
- Vacant land use in Lakewood Village (Manzano & John W. Christian Greenbelt)
- Why are so few things actually recyclable and why are there inconsistencies in documentation?
- 18-wheelers on residential streets that aren't intended for commercial vehicles.
- Improved lighting & safety on trails.
- Homeless situation in neighborhoods and on bay trails (Multiple layers, but need to have a system in place to improve housing affordability so people aren't getting priced out, plus we need resources for those who are already out on the streets.)

This is only a partial list so we encourage you to check out the recording from the meet and greet for more details.
https://youtu.be/SvX4sM5Jxos

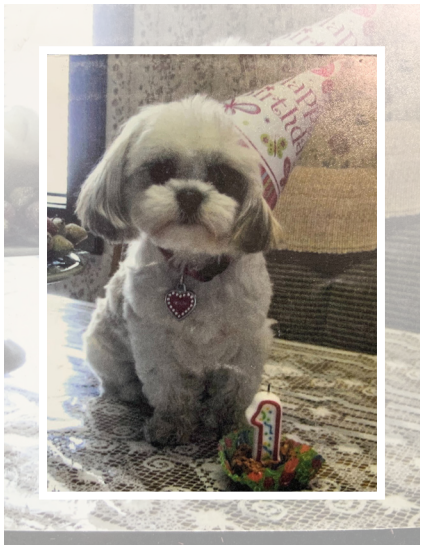
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PET OF THE MONTH



Hi! My name is Reese. I am 7 years old. This picture was taken on my first birthday, but I still look the same. My human dad walks me twice a day and I get to spend a lot of time with my sisters, Lulu and Rey. Lulu is 5 and Rey is 4. We have the same dog (mom and dad). Can't get any better than that! Hopefully when you read this you will get a dog, too. Brings a lot of joy to a family.

Is your pet ready for the Villager spotlight? Submit your caption and photo to editor@lvnasv.org

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If you'd like to submit an article, event, etc., for possible publication in a future edition of the Villager, please send an email to our editor(s) at editor@lvnasv.org



RECIPE CORNER

Cranberry Chia Sauce

16 OZ cranberries, rinsed
½ CUP honey
½ CUP water
½ CUP juiced orange
zest of 1 orange
2 TBSP chia seeds

1. Place cranberries, honey, and water in a medium saucepan. Bring the pot to a boil over medium-high heat and then turn down the heat to medium-low. Stir occasionally and let the mixture simmer for about 10 minutes or until the cranberries have popped and everything has thickened.
2. Remove the pan from the heat and stir in orange zest, juiced orange, and chia seeds.
3. The sauce will continue to thicken as it cools. Transfer sauce from pot to container and refrigerate overnight. Enjoy!

Instyle Beauty Salon, located in Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, is offering readers $150 off microblading, a new and popular procedure that creates the perfect eyebrow!

Normally $450, Instyle Beauty Salon is offering readers $150 off, making it just $300 for the procedure – which also includes the touch-up visit that is recommended within 4-6 weeks of the initial procedure.

Manual microblading is a form of a semi-permanent tattoo that involves using tiny needles (instead of a tattoo gun) that make up a small blade to help deposit pigment under your skin, one by one, for natural looking hair strokes. The procedure takes about an hour to 2 hours and lasts 1.5-2 years before needing to be redone to look fresh. Topical numbing cream is used to maximize comfort. Microblading is perfect for anyone with any hair color and is tailored to each individual client.

For more information and to schedule a consultation, call or text (408) 605-2146.









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IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts and Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety -- General Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety -- Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA ELECTIONS

LVNA board member elections are coming up in March. Are you passionate about our neighborhood? Do you have big ideas and skill sets to bring to the table? Perhaps you should consider running for one of the five board positions in March, 2021! Just like a good democracy, the best way to improve resident representation is to have a diverse candidate pool. Please contact any of the current board members with your notice of interest.

RECOGNITION

The LVNA board would like to thank, and recognize, Cortney Jansen. We made a "Call To Arms" to the Lakewood Village community, asking for ideas to help improve LVNA. Cortney came through with not just one or two, but a whopping 23 ideas! Wow!

Thank you, Cortney!

UPCOMING EVENTS

DECEMBER

09 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

13 holiday light judging begins

JANUARY

13 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Zoom link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

For all Sunnyvale events, please refer to Sunnyvale's online calendar at https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/cals/.

LVNA CRV Recycling Drive

Have cans or bottles to recycle? Email us at recycle@lvnasv.org and one of our volunteers will coordinate a time to swing by to collect them. 100% of the funds will be used for future LVNA neighborhood events and expenses.